I found my $72 check for "The Imaginary" waiting for me and with that, and with Henry Blugerman's untouchable $300, my bank account reached a dizzying height of $854.80. I had no qualms about marriage; I was simply rolling in money.

Also during that week I received the October 1942 Thrilling Wonder, which contained "The Hazing," 2 and earlier I had received the August 1942 Super Science, which had contained "Victory Unintentional." 3 Of all the stories I had sold, only "The Imaginary" remained to be published, and that appeared in the November, 1942 Super Science. 4

With that, it was almost as though the writing part of my life were over, after four years. I didn't entirely abandon it. I did think of a story I called "The Camel's Back," which involved, essentially, the formation of a black hole, decades before astronomers began to talk about black holes, but I never got past the first few pages.

Writing just didn't concern me. Only Gertrude and the job, in that order, did.

4

On August 8, I went to New York once again—for the thirteenth weekend in a row—and on August 9, 1942, I brought Gertrude to Philadelphia. 5

August was, however, most uncomfortable. It was largely humid,

2 See The Early Asimov*

3 See The Rest of the Robots.

4 See The Early Asfmov.

5 In the world outside, the Germans were pushing east of the Don bend toward Stalingrad, and the United States finally began the counteroffensive, eight months after Pearl Harbor, by landing Marines on Guadalcanal in the Solomon Islands.

rainy, or both, and the two of us were living in someone else's house. I had lived there alone for four months and there had been no problems, but why not? I was away daytimes and weekends, and was no trouble to the owners. Once there were two of us, with Gertrude home all day, and both of us all Sunday, things were altogether different. On August 15-16, I spent my first weekend in Philadelphia, alone with Gertrude, and things got very frosty,